UNIVERSITY OF CAMBRIDGE | Institute of Computing for Climate Science

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People Jack Atkinson



Dr Jack Atkinson

Queens' College

Principal Research Software Engineer

Available to supervise masters students Available for consultancy

Contact

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Connect

LinkedIn

ORCID

Symplectic

Google Scholar

Jack Atkinson's website

Location

Roger Needham Building

7 JJ Thomson Avenue, Cambridge , CB3 0RB

About

Jack is a Principal Research Software Engineer (RSE) in the ICCS, where they co-lead our team of 12 RSEs working to support a range of software projects across international climate science projects.

Jack's background is in geophysical fluid dynamics and numerical modelling, having worked as a researcher at Cambridge and at the British Antarctic Survey with various large-scale codes running on high-performance computing systems.

You might know them as:

- lead developer of FTorch, software for coupling PyTorch ML into Fortran, used across scientific computing
- editor at the Journal of Open Source Software
- fellow of the Software Sustainability Institute, exploring the relationship between research publication and the software behind it
- Carpentries Instructor and teacher of software concepts to scientists
- contributor to the RSE community, organiser of the Cambridge RSE Seminar Series and co-founder of the Geoscience-RSE SIG
- convenor of scientific and computing conference sessions at EGU, PASC and more.

Because of their background, Jack is a strong believer in the importance of the 'R' in RSE and enjoys bringing both a technical and scientific understanding to the projects they work on with researchers. They are always open to discussing potential projects and opportunities for the ICCS team.

Outside of climate research Jack is a keen archer, a member of the Archery GB Technical Advisory Group, and maintainer of the archeryutils software library and archerycalculator.co.uk providing modelling resources to the global archery community. For more information, visit Jack's website.

Green DiSC

Jack is one of ICCS's Green DiSC Representatives, leading ICCS's work on the environmental impact of its computing activities. Green DiSC is an open-access Digital Sustainability Certification for research groups, developed at the University of Cambridge and hosted by the Software Sustainability Institute.

In this role, Jack coordinates ICCS's initiatives towards Green DiSC Bronze certification, including tracking inventories of the group's computing hardware, data and infrastructure, and promoting green computing practices through training and shared resources among group members and other research groups. For questions about sustainable computing at ICCS, email Jack.

Research

Research interests

Climate models Interfacing of model components Research software education

Research software efficient design Rethinking relations between publication and software

Teaching and supervision

Available to supervise masters students

Jack has written several teaching courses that have been delivered as workshops across universities and at summer schools and conferences. These include Practical ML with PyTorch, Research Software Skills and Collaboration with git and GitHub. If you would like Jack to deliver one of these courses to your group/lab, please get in touch.

They are also a certified and experienced Carpentries instructor for delivery of various computing skills workshops. Jack has taught at undergraduate level for multiple courses including vectors and matrices, mechanics and dynamics, and fluid mechanics.

Jack has carried out previous supervision of Master's research projects in fluid dynamics and radiation belt physics, and summer projects and internships in research software and scientific research.

Collaborators

Dr Joe Wallwork

Senior Research Software Engineer

Institute of Computing for Climate Science

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